REBECCA JACK

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DOCTORAL STUDIES

Ph.D., Economics, University of Nebraska-Lincoln — 2027 (expected)

REFERENCES

Emily Oster	Daniel Tannenbaum	Brenden Timpe
Professor	Associate Professor	Associate Professor
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
Brown University	University of Nebraska-Lincoln	University of Nebraska-Lincoln
emily@parentdata.org	dtannenbaum@unl.edu	btimpe@unl.edu

PRIOR EDUCATION

M.P.P., Brigham Young University — 2014
B.S., Mathematics, Brigham Young University, *summa cum laude* — 2012

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Labor and Public
Secondary: Gender, Childcare, and Education

EXTERNAL FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant, co-supported by the Washington Center for Equitable Growth — 2026-2027
NBER Pre-Doctoral Fellowship in Gender in the Economy, funded by the Gates Foundation — 2025-2026

UNIVERSITY FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Buffett Early Childhood Institute Graduate Scholarship, University of Nebraska system — 2026-2027
McConnell Fellowship — 2026-2027
Bingham Teaching Fellowship — 2024-2025
UNL College of Business Ph.D. Student Research Award — 2024
Ogle Fellowship — 2021-2025
Othmer Fellowship — 2021-2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Daniel Tannenbaum, Dr. Brenden Timpe — 2022-present
Research Director, COVID-19 School Data Hub, Dr. Emily Oster — 2020-2023
Research Assistant, Dr. Olga Stoddard — 2013-2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Introduction to Econometrics, Instructor of Record	2024
Principles of Macroeconomics, Teaching Assistant	2022
Honors Principles of Macroeconomics, Teaching Assistant	2021

PRESENTATIONS

2026: AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, NBER Gender in the Economy Spring Meeting
2025: AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, W.E. Upjohn Institute seminar
2024: Bozeman Applied Economics Conference, Chicago Fed, SEA Annual Meeting
2023: SEA Annual Meeting, Federal Statistical Research Data Center Annual Research Conference, Nebraska Labor Summit

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE

Nebraska Labor Summit Committee	2023-present
Economics Graduate Student Activities Organizer, University of Nebraska	2021-2025
Department of Economics Undergraduate Committee, University of Nebraska	2022-2023
Becker Friedman Price Theory Camp, University of Chicago	2023
NBER Health Economics Research Boot Camp	2022

Refereeing: *Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Feminist Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Empirical Economics*

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Afterschool Care Subsidies and Maternal Employment"

Abstract: Afterschool care addresses the gap between the school day and the full-time workday. I study how afterschool care affects maternal employment using the staggered rollout of 21st Century Community Learning Center grants. I collect a novel dataset on these grants and build a precise geographic linkage with individuals in restricted-access Census Bureau data. I find that while overall maternal employment does not change, Black and other minority non-Hispanic mothers are 6.2 percentage points more likely to work full time when their nearest elementary school receives a grant. At the same time, women living near these schools are 0.67 percentage points less likely to report working in a care occupation. Among mothers, the decline in care occupation is driven by Hispanic mothers (-1.03 pp). Because mothers both use and provide childcare, understanding its effect on maternal employment requires measuring effects on both.

PEER-REVIEWED ECONOMICS PUBLICATIONS

"Pandemic Schooling Mode and Student Test Scores: Evidence from US School Districts." (with Clare Halloran, James Okun, and Emily Oster), *American Economic Review: Insights, 5(2),* 2023.

Abstract: We estimate the impact of district-level schooling mode (in-person versus hybrid or virtual learning) in the 2020–2021 school year on students' pass rates on standardized tests in grades 3–8 across 11 states. Pass rates declined from 2019 to 2021: an average of 12.8 percentage points in math and 6.8 in English language arts (ELA). Focusing on within-state, within-commuting zone variation in schooling mode, we estimate that districts with full in-person learning had significantly smaller declines (13.4 pp in math, 8.3 in ELA). The value to in-person learning was larger for districts with larger populations of Black students.

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

"The Landscape of Parental Leave-Taking in the United States." (with Daniel Tannenbaum and Brenden Timpe), revise and resubmit at *AEJ: Economic Policy*.

> *Abstract:* Despite its importance for maternal health, child well-being and gender equality, little is known about parents' work and leave-taking in the weeks around childbirth. Leveraging new data linkages, this paper shows that roughly one-quarter of mothers actively work in the first weeks postpartum. Parental leave lasts 7.2 weeks for mothers and 3 days for fathers. Despite expanding access to benefits, maternity leave has declined in recent decades. We supplement these findings with a novel analysis of time use data in the first 5 months of parenthood, showing that parental leave is associated with greater childcare and educational investments from parents.

WORKING PAPERS

"Sick Days, Snow Days, and the Labor Market Impacts of Caretaking Inequities." (with Garrett Anstreicher)

> *Abstract:* We study how unexpected childcare disruptions impact the labor market outcomes of U.S. parents. We find in the Current Population Survey and time use data that mothers are more likely to miss work in response to increased snow or illness exposure while fathers show little change, with especially strong effects among married mothers in occupations with low time flexibility. Finally, we find that mothers in areas with higher average annual snowfall work in occupations with higher time flexibility but lower pay, suggesting that mothers may adjust their labor supply in anticipation of future possible childcare disruptions.

"The Parenthood Gap: Firms, Flexibility, and Earnings Inequality After Kids." (with Daniel Tannenbaum and Brenden Timpe), *Upjohn Institute working paper*: 25-412, 2025.

> *Abstract:* This paper uses job ads data and a linkage between U.S. administrative and large-scale survey data to provide evidence that flexible work amenities are rigid at the firm level and concentrated at employers with low earnings premia. A key source of the gender earnings gap is the transition to lower-paying firms after parenthood: mothers are "opting down" rather than opting out of the labor force. Mothers gain amenities consistent with increased flexibility—remote work, part-time employment, and reduced commuting time—but they are also more likely to lose health insurance, reflecting a trade-off between flexibility and other workplace benefits.

"Post COVID-19 Test Score Recovery: Initial Evidence from State Testing Data." (with Clare Halloran, Claire Hug, and Emily Oster), *NBER Working Paper*: 31113, 2023.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

"COVID-19, School Closures, and Outcomes." (with Emily Oster), *Journal of Economic Perspectives,* 2023.

"Gender Salience and Chat-Based Communication in Teams." *AEA Papers and Proceedings,* 2025.

"Effectiveness of Three versus Six Feet of Physical Distancing for Controlling Spread of COVID-19 among Primary and Secondary Students and Staff: A Retrospective, State-Wide Cohort Study." (with Polly van den Berg, Elissa Perkins, Isabella Epshtein, Richard Nelson, Emily Oster, and Westyn Branch-Elliman), *Clinical Infectious Diseases*, 2021.

"Disparities in Learning Mode Access among K–12 Students during the COVID-19 Pandemic, by Race/Ethnicity, Geography, and Grade Level—United States, September 2020–April 2021." (with Emily Oster, Clare Halloran, John Schoof, Diana McLeod, Haisheng Yang, Julie Roche, and Dennis Roche), *Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report*, 2021, 70(26), p.953.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"The Continuing Impact of COVID-19 School Closures on Teenagers"